team demonstrated the ability within our squad: Graeme and Hashim as openers, followed by Jacques, me, JP and Faf, with Johan Botha and Robin Peterson as all-rounders, Dale and Morné leading the pace attack and Imran Tahir as the spinner.

We felt confident and we played in a confident manner, decisively defeating the West Indies in Delhi, overcoming the Netherlands in Mohali, losing narrowly to England in Chennai, but recovering our form to defeat India in Nagpur and secure convincing wins over Ireland and Bangladesh. With five wins from our six group matches, we finished in first place in Group B, and progressed purposefully to the quarterfinals.

I was keeping wicket, a job that was not my first preference, but which I was prepared to do for the team and, as a batsman, quietly, I felt in great nick – maybe the best form of my life.

Chasing 223 against the West Indies, I had come in at 20 for two and managed to score 107 from 105 balls, building a partnership with JP and guiding us to victory with seven overs to spare. Batting first against the Dutch, we were wobbling at 58 for two when Hashim and I added 221 for the third wicket. Hash scored 113 and I made 134 from 98 balls, enabling us to post what proved a match-winning total of 351 in our 50 overs.

Our match against India was billed as a highlight of the tepid group phase, and few were disappointed. Tendulkar scored a fine century, Virender Sehwag and Gautam Gambhir also scored runs, and the home team powered to 267 for one with 10 overs remaining. Our bowlers then staged an almost unbelievable fightback, taking nine wickets for 29 runs in the space of nine overs, dismissing India for a still-competitive total of 296.

It was hot. It was noisy. It was intense. We knew we would have to bat well, and we did. Hash and Jacques laid the ideal foundation. I was pleased to contribute 52 in 39 balls, injecting momentum into the run chase at an important stage, and Faf and Robin took us over the line with two balls to spare.